

Google brings reCAPTCHA API to Android

Ten years after beginning to offer protection to Web users, Google has now taken a step towards protecting mobile devices and brought its renowned reCAPTCHA API to Android. The move is to protect Android users from spam and abuse, as well as countermeasures by its competitors in the smartphone space, which include Apple and Microsoft.

"With this API, reCAPTCHA can better tell human and bots apart to provide a streamlined user experience on the mobile," said Wei Liu, product manager for reCAPTCHA, Google, in a blog post.

Available as a part of Google Play Services, the reCAPTCHA Android API comes along with Google SafetyNet that provides



services such as device attestation and safe

browsing to protect mobile apps. The combination enables developers to perform both the device and user attestations using the same API.

Carnegie Mellon alumni Luis von Ahn, Ben Maurer, Colin McMillen, David Abraham and Manuel Blum built reCAPTCHA as a CAPTCHA-like system back in 2007. The development was acquired by Google two years after its inception, in September 2009. The solution has benefited more than a billion users so far.

Google is not just limiting the access of reCAPTCHA to Android but also plans to bring it to Apple's iOS as well. It would be interesting to see how it is adopted by iOS developers. Meanwhile, you can use the reCAPTCHA Android Library under SafetyNet APIS to integrate the secured solution into your Android apps.

technology," said Keiji Yamamoto, executive vice president of the connected company division, Toyota Motor Corporation.

Hosted by the Linux Foundation, AGL presently has more than 100 members



who are developing a common platform to serve as the *de facto* industry standard. The Linux-based operating system comes with an application framework that allows automakers and suppliers to customise the experience with their specific features, services and branding.

According to Automotive Grade Linux executive director, Dan Cauchy, among all the AGL members, Toyota is one of the

more active contributors, "Toyota has been a driving force behind the development of the AGL infotainment platform, and we are excited to see the traction that it is gaining across the industry," said Cauchy.

Around 70 per cent of the AGL-based platform on the latest Toyota Camry sedan is said to have generic coding, while the remaining 30 per cent includes customised inputs. There are features like multimedia access and navigation.

In the future, the Linux Foundation and AGL partners are planning to deploy the open source platform for building even unmanned vehicles. This model could make competition tougher for emerging players including Google and Tesla, which are both currently testing their self-driving cars.

In addition to automotive companies like Toyota and Daimler, AGL is supported by tech leaders such as Intel, Renesas, Texas Instruments and Qualcomm. The open source community built AGL Unified Code Base 3.0 in December last year to kickstart developments towards the next-generation auto space.

Perl 5.26.0 is now out with tons of improvements

The Perl community has received version 26 of Perl 5. This new release is a collaborative effort from 86 authors.

Perl 5.26.0 contains approximately 360,000 lines of code across 2600 files. Most of the changes in the latest version have originated in the CPAN



(Comprehensive Perl Archive Network) modules. According to the official changelog, new variables such as `@{^CAPTURE}`, `%{^CAPTURE}` and `%{^CAPTURE_ALL}` are included in the Perl 5.26.0 release.

"Excluding auto-generated files, documentation and release tools, there were approximately 230,000 lines of changes to 1,800 .pm, .t, .c and .h files,"

Perl developer Sawyer X wrote in an email announcement.

The new version comes with some improvements like 'here-docs' can now strip leading whitespace. The original `POSIX::tmpnam()` command has also been replaced with `File::Temp`. Moreover, lexical sub-routines that were debuted with the Perl 5.18 are no longer experimental.

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